

What is ATHX?

A plain guide for athletes who keep seeing the name and haven't got round to finding out.

ATHX is a hybrid fitness competition. It started in the UK in 2023, it is backed by adidas, and in 2027 it runs in more than twenty cities across Europe, five of them in the UK and Ireland.

If you have done a HYROX or a CrossFit competition you will recognise a lot of it. The shape of the day is different enough, though, that it is worth understanding properly before you enter one.

HOW THE DAY WORKS

You are at the venue for about two and a half hours, completing three separate tests called zones with recovery between them. You are not racing continuously from a gun to a finish line. Total working time is around sixty-nine minutes, spread across a long morning or afternoon.

THE THREE ZONES

ZONE	TIME	WHAT YOU DO	HOW IT IS SCORED
Strength	15 min	A one-rep max shoulder to overhead, a two-rep max back squat, then a three-rep max deadlift. Warm-up time is inside the fifteen minutes.	Total weight lifted, in kilograms
Endurance	24 min	A 3 km run, then maximum distance on the SkiErg for whatever time is left inside the cap.	Ski metres only
MetCon X	25 min cap	Row, dumbbell ground to overhead, dumbbell bench press, sandbag squats, a 30 m sandbag carry, burpees over a bench, then row again.	Time taken to finish

HOW THE SCORING WORKS

Each zone gives you a placing rather than a raw number. Your final score is the sum of the three placings, and the lowest total wins. Winning a zone outright is worth one point, whether you take it by four metres or forty. A bad zone tends to cost you more than a good one gains.

THREE THINGS THAT SURPRISE PEOPLE

- The run does not score. It is a buy-in. The faster you cover the 3 km, the more time you have left on the SkiErg, and only the skiing counts towards your placing.
- There is a genuine one-rep max. Most hybrid racing never asks you to lift something heavy once. This does, and it comes early, with your warm-up inside the clock.
- Nothing is relative to your bodyweight. Kilos lifted, metres skied, fixed loads moved. The only place extra muscle costs you is a run that does not score, so mass tends to be an asset here rather than a tax.

IS IT WORTH A GO?

Probably yes if you lift and want it to count for something, or if running has been the thing holding your times back. Probably not yet if you have never taken a heavy triple.

Divisions are Lite, ATHX and Pro, as an individual or a pair. Pairs is the easiest way in for a first one.

UK AND IRELAND, 2027

London	23-24 January
Glasgow	5-6 June
Dublin	12-13 June
Birmingham	20-22 August
Liverpool	9-10 October

Plus Paris, Madrid, Milan, Berlin, Amsterdam and others across Europe.